

Manel Leiva

Senior Product Designer, Design Systems

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Barcelona

SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 15 years designing complex B2B products.

Built two production design systems from scratch, including the token pipeline from Token Studio through Style Dictionary to a published npm package with CI validation.

Works on data-heavy workflows directly with engineering, product, and business stakeholders.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

Built the component library and token pipeline from scratch: Token Studio to Style Dictionary to npm, with CI validation and the W3C token format.

Ran an ongoing product audit across the full tenure: captured every UI pattern instance, defined its variants and states, then decided fix-now versus defer-into-an-upcoming-feature for each one.

Introduced Figma variables and a structured token architecture; the CTO described the change as going from a 2010 app to a 2020 app.

Hardened the pipeline with AI-assisted drift checks and smoke tests; engineers reviewed and merged the work.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

Built the Abax design system alongside product work: two-tier token architecture and a Token Studio to Style Dictionary to npm pipeline, adopted across five squads.

Co-led the design system business case with the head of design and presented it to engineering leadership.

Ran a structured issue-reporting system with a naming-proposals category, and shipped new components under feature flags so squads added their own migration tickets instead of a central team gatekeeping rollout.

Set adoption targets up front (80% of new UI from Abax components, 100% legacy deprecation) and tracked them by counting components in the codebase.

Senior UX Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

Co-founded and led a UX studio for 11 years; end-to-end product design for clients in media, retail, finance, legal, and culture.

Built much of what I designed: component libraries in Sketch mapped to front-end code, and by 2020 a shared front-end starter kit with a build pipeline and a CSS variables settings layer.

Taught UX and digital design at postgraduate level.

SKILLS

Systems: Design tokens, Style Dictionary, component architecture, ESLint adoption rules

Design: Figma, Figma Make, Token Studio, Storybook, Chromatic

Prototyping: Figma Make (Claude-powered), high-fidelity interaction design

Research: Structured user testing, synthesis, Jobs to Be Done

Collaboration: Cross-functional facilitation, engineering alignment, stakeholder presentations

Tools: GitHub, npm, VSCode, Vercel

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002